

Hekapider – Backstory Summary

Hekapider was born on the 5th day of the 8th month during the 2nd year of the Tiancheng era , but her parents' identities remain a mystery even to her. She was orphaned as an infant and spent her earliest years surviving in a small mountain village nestled near the foothills where several respected martial sects trained. With no family to claim her, she became something of a communal child. The villagers could not afford to formally adopt another mouth to feed, yet few could bring themselves to turn away a cheerful little girl. Different families would quietly leave her scraps of food, allow her to sleep in their barns or workshops during harsh weather, and keep a watchful eye on her from a distance. Though she never truly belonged anywhere, she was never completely abandoned.

Growing up without a permanent home forced Heka to become remarkably resourceful. She learned to climb trees before she could properly write, knew every hidden footpath through the surrounding forests, and developed an uncanny ability to disappear whenever an angry merchant discovered a missing steamed bun. Despite the hardships, she refused to become bitter. She possessed an infectious optimism that often disarmed those around her, and her mischievous curiosity frequently outweighed any sense of self-preservation.



Everything changed when she discovered a nearby martial sect hidden among the mountains. Fascinated by the disciples' grace and discipline, Heka began secretly climbing the surrounding trees each day to watch their training. She spent months—possibly close to a year—carefully observing their routines, memorizing sword forms, footwork, and breathing exercises entirely through imitation. Although she lacked any understanding of internal cultivation or martial principles, her determination allowed her to reproduce many movements surprisingly well for an untrained child.

Her secret observations eventually came to an abrupt end when she lost her footing while hiding in the branches overlooking the training grounds. Before she struck the ground, the sect's master, GNS, caught her effortlessly. Expecting punishment for trespassing and stealing fruit from the orchards, Heka instead found herself facing gentle curiosity. Master GNS simply asked why she had spent so much time secretly watching the disciples train.

Heka answered with complete honesty. She confessed that she wanted to become strong enough to protect people, particularly those who could not protect themselves. Having spent her childhood relying upon the kindness of strangers, she understood better than most how vulnerable ordinary people could be. Rather than seeing a troublesome thief, Master GNS saw extraordinary sincerity and compassion within the young girl.

Recognizing that genuine kindness could not be taught as easily as martial techniques, Master GNS chose to adopt Heka into the sect instead of punishing her. She was given a proper name, a home, regular meals, formal martial training, and, for the first time in her life, a family. The sect became more than a place of cultivation—it became the home she had never known. Fellow disciples became brothers and sisters, while Master GNS became the mother figure Heka had never had.

Although Heka eventually grew into an exceptionally talented martial artist, her greatest strength was never her swordsmanship. Her years as an orphan instilled an unwavering empathy for the forgotten, the poor, and the vulnerable. She has little patience for injustice, rarely hesitates to help strangers, and often risks herself without considering the consequences if someone else might be saved. Her cheerful personality is genuine rather than a mask; she chooses to face life with warmth because she remembers how profoundly small acts of kindness changed the course of her own life.

Master GNS's teachings became the foundation of Heka's worldview. While many martial artists pursue fame, prestige, or personal power, Heka believes strength exists to shelter others. Every person she rescues, every wandering soul she offers a meal, and every frightened child she comforts is, in her mind, another opportunity to pass

forward the compassion that once transformed an orphan hiding in the trees into someone worthy of being called a hero.